

Local Area Engagement Plan – Chiltern Tunnel

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1 Situation analysis

1.1 Context

C1 starts at Harvil Road, north of Ickenham as the route begins to rise on embankment until the start of the Colne Valley Viaduct. The Viaduct crosses the valley before reaching the A412, passing west of West Hyde in a series of cuttings and embankments before entering the Chiltern Tunnel via the south portal, immediately east of the M25 motorway. C1 then runs in twin bore tunnels beneath the communities of Chalfont St Peter, Chalfont St Giles, Amersham, Little Missenden before exiting the tunnel at the north portal near South Heath.

1.2 Our approach

High quality, inclusive and transparent engagement runs through everything we do in area C1. In addition, we are committed to a ‘no surprises’ approach, acknowledging anticipated impacts and identifying mitigation where possible to keep communities informed.

HS2 Ltd has been clear that a neighbourly approach to our work is fundamental, and we are committed to respecting all residents, businesses and those who represent them. We have adopted the ten community commitments outlined in HS2 Ltd’s Community Engagement Strategy, Respecting People, Respecting Places, to inform and shape our work, from planning to implementation.

We will continue to use HS2 Ltd’s Community Engagement Framework, Community Engagement Strategy and WI 875 Community Engagement, including the community engagement index and communications documents as the fundamental basis for all we do and embed HS2 Ltd’s values of Integrity, Leadership, Respect and Safety.

1.3 Work areas and compounds

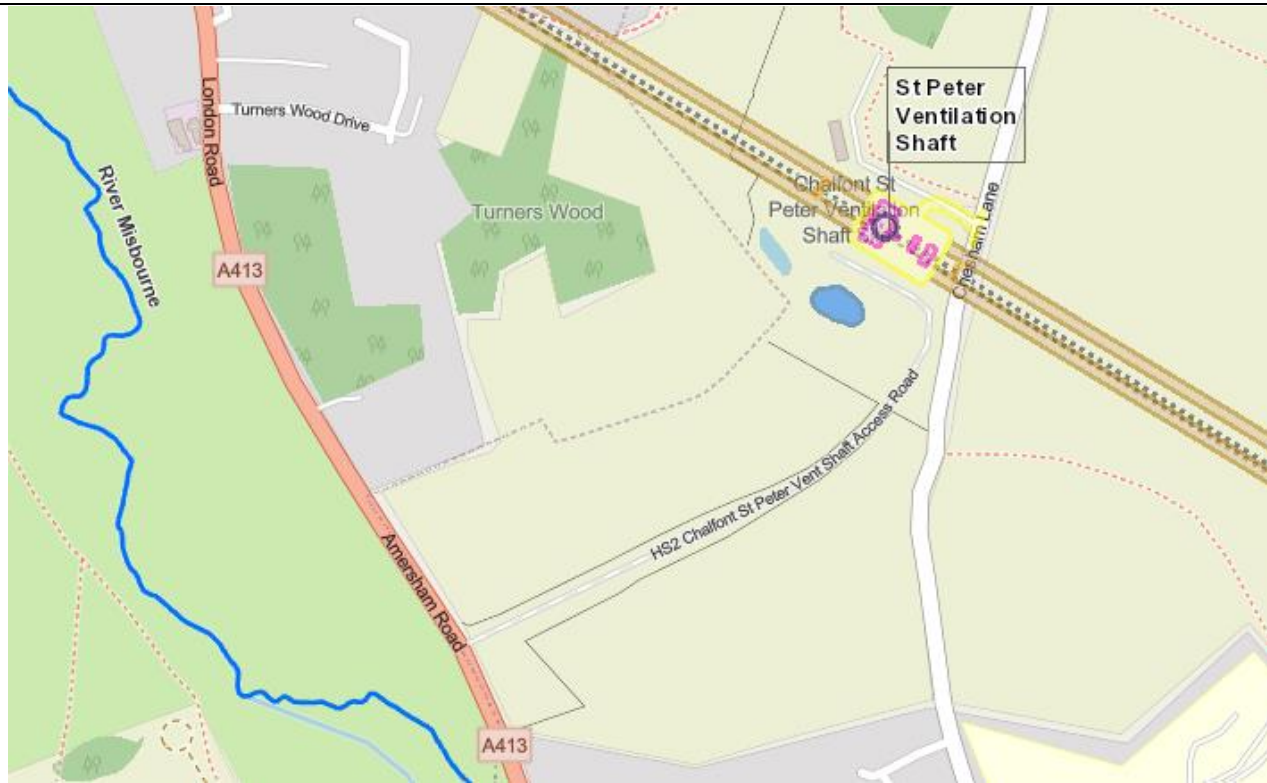
This engagement plan covers the Chiltern Tunnel and its four ventilation shafts at Chalfont St Peter, Chalfont St Giles, Amersham and Little Missenden as well as the intervention shaft off Chesham Road and the North Portal where the trains will exit the tunnel.

Enabling works began on some sites in 2018, especially where habitat mitigation zones were being created. Other enabling works, such as the building of temporary access roads, fencing and some vegetation clearance began in 2019 to prepare some of the sites for main works construction. Main work construction began after Notice to Proceed on 15 April 2020.

The main works compounds and their functions are as follows:

Chalfont St Peter

Location: The vent shaft site (SL9 0PJ) is set back off Chesham Road in Buckinghamshire and accessed by a temporary access road from the A413 for HGVs and a bell-mouth from Chesham Lane for all other vehicles.



Context: The creation of the temporary access road has mitigated much of the impact the shaft site has on the community. Several households back onto the vent shaft site and they have been actively engaged with during the construction to date. Residents living about 200 metres away have also been impacted by light and noise from the site, and the engagement team continue to work with the site team and environment team to address this. The shaft site borders a Public Right of Way (PROW) that is popular with residents. The field to the northwest of the site is under DfT control, and part of it had been fenced off for boreholes in the event they were needed for water discharge from the site. These boreholes have since been removed and the land remediated. There is also an area that has been taken for an environmental mitigation zone. Both areas have been of great interest to residents of The Brow and Valentine Way as the field adjacent to the vent shaft has been frequently used by residents as unofficial common land.

An extension of the TAR until at least 2027 has been approved and we expect to leave this intact for the incoming Rail Systems contractor when we demobilise from the site in Summer 2025. The landscaping has been descoped from Align and will be carried out by a future contractor accordingly.

Key concerns: Noise from the shaft site, lighting from the shaft site, dust from TAR and transference to A413, non-adherence to HGV routes, possibility of TAR being formally adopted and used for local housebuilders on the site around CSP is a key concern of residents going forward. Local flooding issues on the surrounding roads continue to be a concern exacerbated during winter months and heavy downpours.

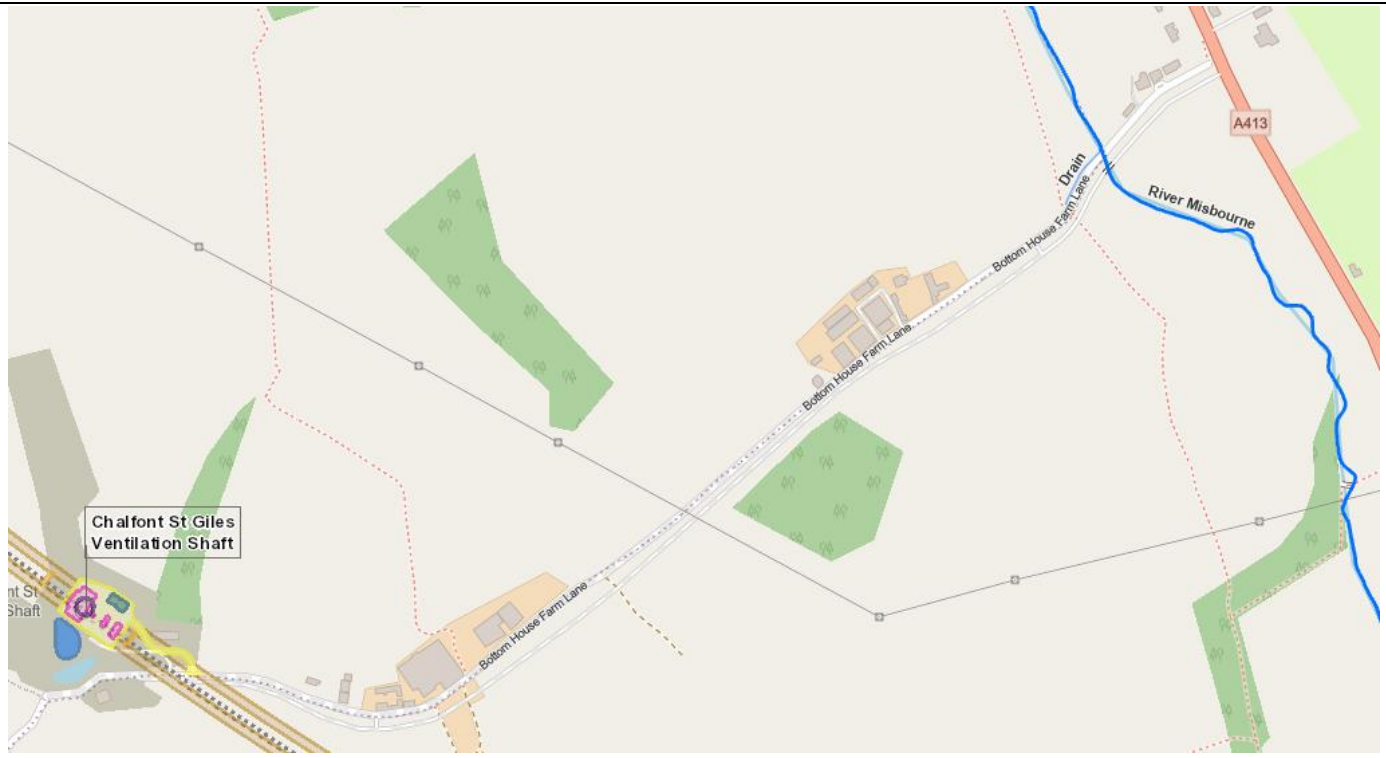
Construction and engagement milestones for 2025/2026:

Works	Activity completed by:
Lightning Protection	May 2025
Internal Works	July 2025
Safe stopping prior to Rail Systems handover	August 2025
Demobilisation	August 2025

Handover Key Date expected: March 2026

Chalfont St Giles

Location: The Chalfont St Giles vent shaft site (HP8 4EF) is the most remote of the shaft sites, located on Bottom House Farm Lane, off the A413 in Buckinghamshire. HGV access to the site is via a temporary access road from the A413.



Summary: The construction at Chalfont St Giles impacts a small number of stakeholders and businesses. The construction of the temporary access road to the site generated a high level of concern amongst residents. These enabling works were undertaken by Fusion, who undertook a considerable amount of engagement to keep residents informed. The access road was completed in March 2021. Noise, vibration and loss of privacy due to the installation of the temporary access road are the main ongoing concerns. There are two Public Rights of Way intersecting with the site. The River Misbourne crosses the area about 400 metres from the A413. A temporary bridge has been installed to carry the temporary access road. This has led to speculation amongst residents and stakeholders that it has led to flooding and environmental impact. We have recently completed some drainage improvement to the first crossover point. In early 2024 we installed additional traffic calming measures. An extension of the TAR until at least 2027 has been approved and we expect to leave this intact for the incoming Rail Systems contractor when we demobilise from the site in September 2025. Landscaping at the vent shaft will now be carried out by Rail Systems contractors

Key concerns: Screening for houses from HGVs using the TAR, unauthorised/speeding on TAR by members of the public and threat of local farmer actions to disrupt works usually due to issues/delay with payments. Security concerns due to the removal of manned security. Localised flooding and drainage issues near crossover with Bottom House Farm Lane. In addition to the condition of Bottom House Farm Lane where it joins Bottrell's Lane. Most recently there have been several noise and vibration complaints relating to the walkway autopaving works. This will need to be carefully managed by the incoming contractor when rail systems undertake any potentially noisy works

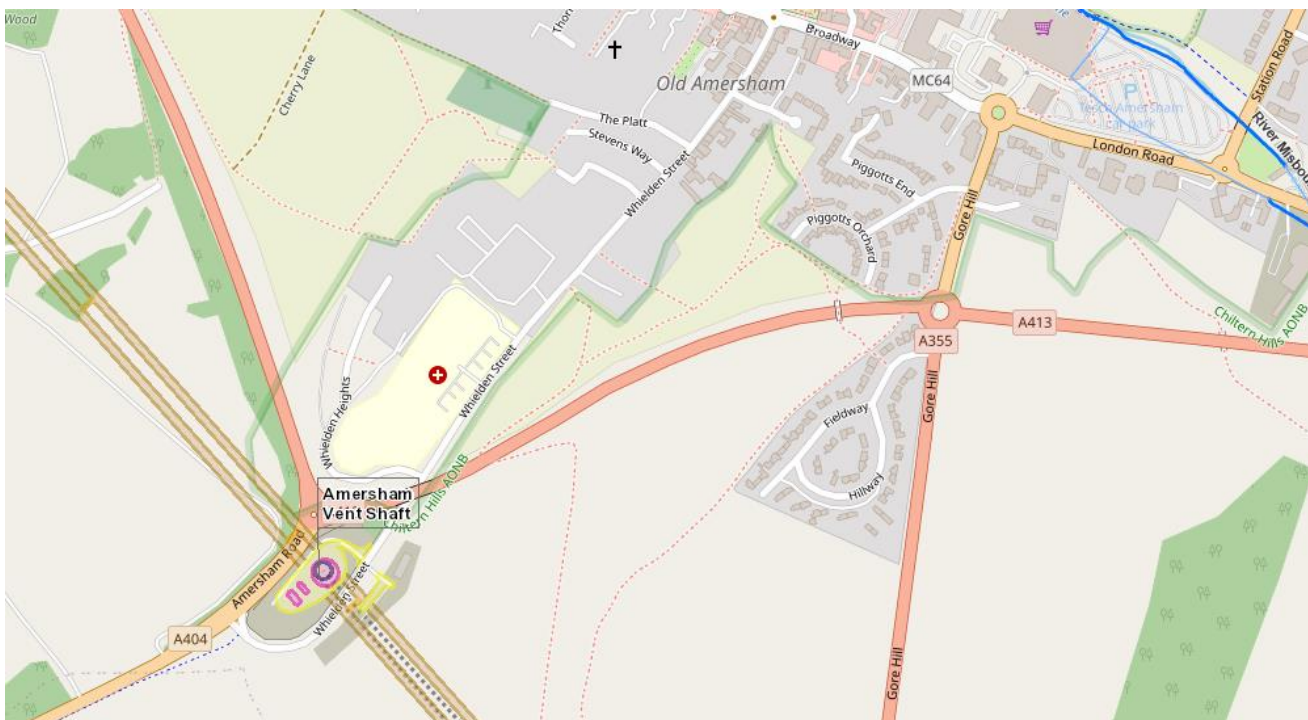
Construction and engagement milestones for 2025/2026

Works activity	Activity completed by:
Lightning Protection	June 2025
Internal Works	July 2025
Demobilisation	September 2025

Handover Key Date expected: April 2026

Amersham

Location: Situated on the outskirts of Amersham Old Town (HP7 0JD), the vent shaft is separated from the old town by a large modern built community hospital and an overpass of the A413. The site is surrounded by main roads (A413/A404) and a major intersection of these roads. The site support buildings and car park are located on the opposite side of Whielden Street on former farmland. A Schedule 17 application for a change in the production and design of the flint surround screening wall at Amersham was approved by Buckinghamshire Council in March and the production and installation of this outer compound wall is one of the last items that Align will deliver at the ventilation shaft compound. Community groups and local stakeholders universally approved of the changed design when engaged with in autumn and winter 2025.



Key concerns: Ensuring HGVs do not use Whielden Street to access the site, a U&A exists to ensure compliance and prevent staff parking on Whielden Street and in the Old Town, impact on the River Misbourne/chalk aquifer, congestion on the road network. A local councillor actively undertakes his own surveillance of HS2 vehicles and other lorries, he also has an interest and concern regarding ground movement in the area.

Construction and engagement milestones for 2025/2026:

Mechanical/Electrical/Plumbing installation – February 2025

Headhouse lift – April 26

Completion of external works – drainage, services, earthworks – June 2025

Flint wall installation – July 2025

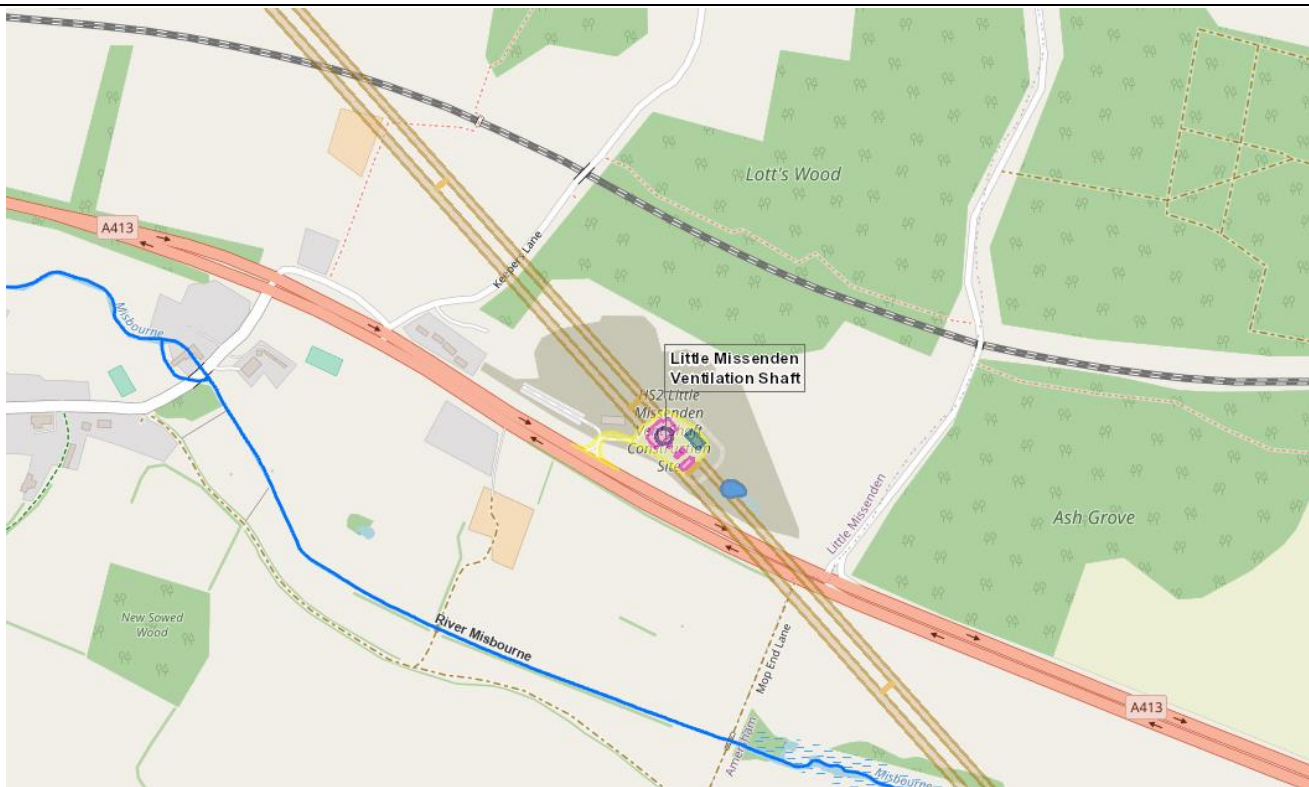
Demobilisation – December 2025

Landscaping – September 2025

Handover Key Date – April 2026

Little Missenden

Location: The site sits off the eastbound carriageway of the A413 (HP7 0RH) and is just to the southeast of the village of Little Missenden.



Summary: Traffic for both Align and EKFB using the A413 to access the M40/M25 has been the biggest local concern in recent years but has eased off substantially as Align construction nears completion. Both Little Missenden and Hyde Heath villages, to the north of the site, have primary schools. There is concern that rat running vehicles caused by displacement of vehicles from the A413 creates more danger for local populations and that parents will be put off sending their children to these local schools if high numbers of HS2 vehicles create congestion. A signalised junction from the westbound carriageway of the A413 and across the eastbound carriageway was completed in 2021 and is effective in managing access to site but was the focus of

stakeholder concern and petition. A small and very organised group of councillors are engaged on all aspects of the Chiltern Tunnel in this area, however, a concerted effort to deal with local concerns directly via engagement has improved the relationship considerably. Meetings have decreased due to the efforts undertaken by the engagement team in forging a much more collaborative relationship.

Key concerns: Driver behaviour, non-adherence to HGV routes, impact on the River Misbourne/chalk aquifer, congestion on the road network/displacement of non HS2 traffic onto surrounding local roads to avoid congestion, impact on local schools, perceived congestion on the A413 and local roads caused by HS2 deliveries, HGVs off route and the Shardeloes and Hyde Heath ground movements.

Construction and Engagement milestones 2025/2026:

Completion of external works – drainage, services, earthworks – July 2025

Headhouse internal finishes – August 2025

Lightning Protection – August 2025

Landscaping completion – August 2025

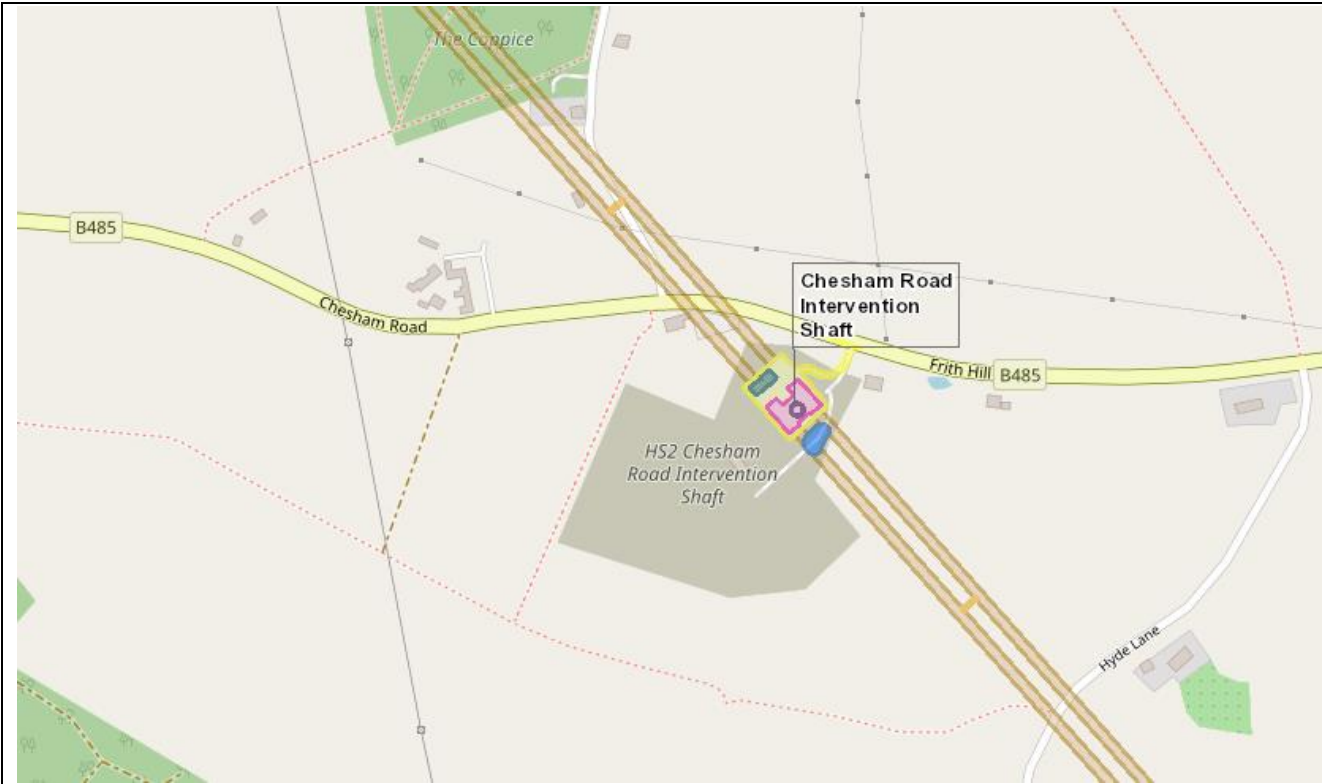
Demobilisation – September 2025

Safe Stopping prior to Rail Systems Handover - September 2025

Handover Key Date expected: September 2025

Chesham Road (Hyde End)

Location: This site sits off the B485 which links the village of Great Missenden with the market town of Chesham (HP16 0RD).



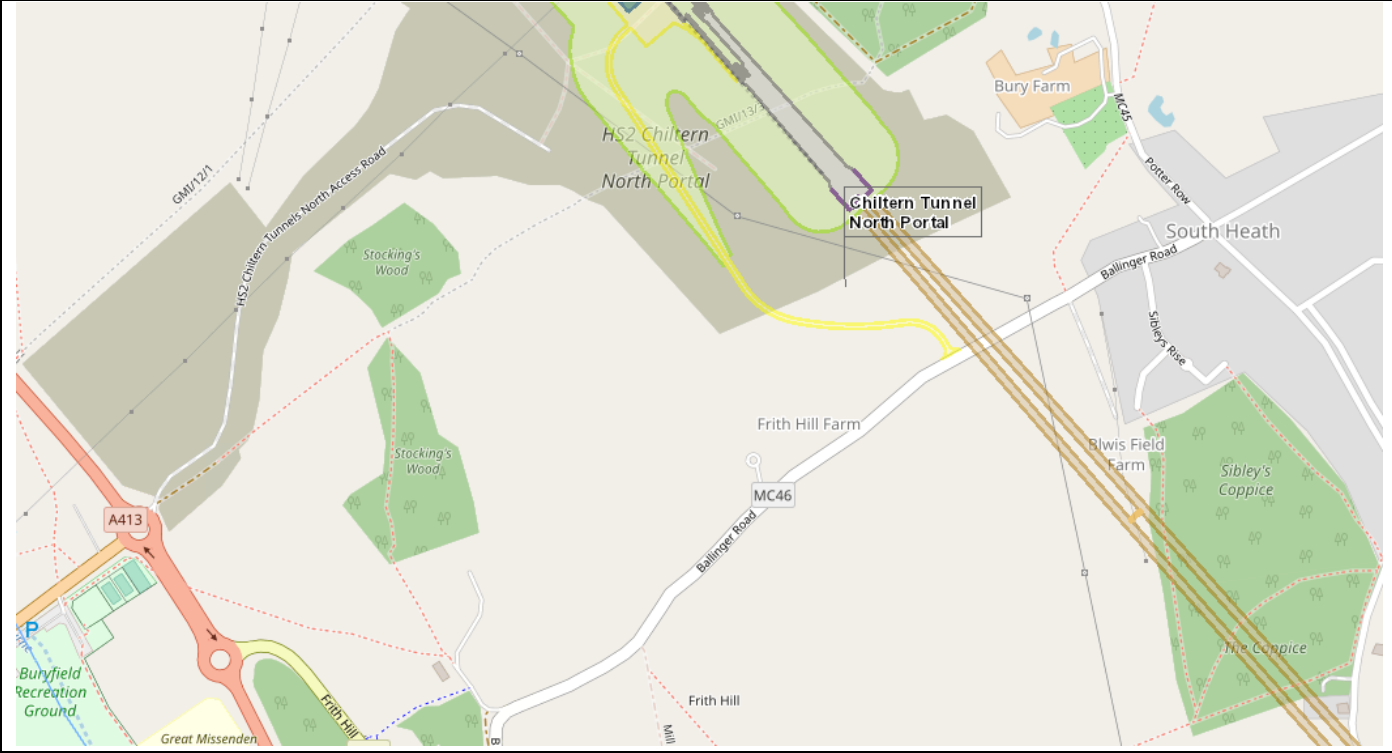
Summary: This will not be a ventilation shaft, but an intervention shaft for emergency services. Its method of construction is different to the ventilation shafts. This site is also rural in location, however access to it is via key roads, with any displaced non HS2 traffic potentially using Hyde Heath village as a rat run. It is also the site just before the North Portal of the Chiltern Tunnel.

Key concerns: Non-adherence to HGV routes, impact on the River Misbourne/chalk aquifer, congestion on the road network/displacement of non HS2 traffic onto surrounding local roads to avoid congestion. UKPN works to install power to the site have been delayed and cancellations have been frustrating for residents. A ground movement occurred in November2023 in Hyde Lane just behind the site. This impacted a local resident who had to relocate livestock from the field and has caused concerns to their neighbours. The adjacent PROW was closed for remedial work. This remedial work has now been completed and the ground restored. Ongoing monitoring will continue.

Construction and Engagement milestones 2025/2026:

Completion of shaft internal structures – August 2025
Completion of external works (drainage, services, earthworks) – July 2025
Landscaping – October 2025
Demobilisation – November 2025

Handover Key Date expected: April 2026

North Portal (South Heath)
Location: This site sits off Frith Hill just outside of Great Missenden (HP16 9LT) and is accessed via a temporary access road from A413 junction with Link Road.

Summary: Align is responsible for the engineering of the North Portal and ancillary buildings, the surrounding site itself was due to be landscaped by EKFB, however, landscaping works have now been allocated to Align. Align and EKFB are working together on engagement in this area, attending joint meetings of the local parish councils. Two sinkholes emerged early 2024 in a field in South Heath above the tunnels, they have both been remediated. Align’s works in 2024 which saw increasing work and activity does not appear to have had an undue impact on the immediate community as the dismantling of the TBMs were completed following their successful breakthrough and the site entered 24/7 batching plant operations to construct the walkways.
Key concerns: Noise, lighting, non-adherence to HGV routes, congestion on the road network/displacement of non HS2 traffic onto surrounding local roads. In addition to local Cllr Mike Johnstone seeking input into the design of the realigned footpath GM1/13 and link to Frith Hill
Construction and engagement milestones 2025/2026
Ancillary building FRC – July 2025

Porous Portal construction – October 2025

Building external cladding – January 2026

Demobilisation – June 2026

Completion date – June 2026

External works – September 2026

Handover Key Date expected: September 2026

Key Design Elements (KDEs)

Each shaft headhouse is a Key Design Element. This means that we are contractually obliged to formally present our designs to stakeholders and members of the public for engagement as part of the planning process. To date we have completed design engagement events covering shaft headhouse construction; ecology, landscaping and construction activity asking stakeholders to rank six priorities against each one, for Chalfont St Peter, Chalfont St Giles, Amersham, Little Missenden, Chesham Road Intervention Shaft, and the North Portal. These priorities were then analysed, and changes made to the designs where practical or as required by the local planning authority.

The engagement events were then followed up a few months later and ‘You Said, We Did’ event to reflect updated plans.

To date, design engagement events have been held for Chalfont St Peter, Chalfont St Giles, Amersham, Little Missenden, Chesham Road, and the North Portal. A ‘You Said, We Did’ event for North Portal was held in March 2023.

A ‘meet the contractor’ drop-in was held on 7 December 2023 in Great Missenden Memorial Hall.

This concluded our formal KDE level engagement on C1, however we will maintain the same standards of engagement principles and quality of information when progressing any known or unanticipated design engagement in the future.

We expect to undertake further design engagement to cover changes to the surrounding flint wall at Amersham in early 2025 and will abide by the same high standards of engagement that we have maintained to date for all public comms.

Overview of engagement

Many of the key concerns are common across the shaft sites. Working with HS2, we have produced Frequently Asked Questions documents (FAQs) covering water treatment and protection, and ground movements associated with tunnelling to help inform stakeholders. Our planned engagement for the year will also include a series of both online and engagement events where stakeholders can meet with us to ask questions.

We held our annual construction review webinar in November 2024 which celebrated the progress and achievements on C1 in 2024. This included highlights of construction in both the Chiltern hills and the Colne Valley. We will also be looking to hold an engagement event for the Amersham flint wall in 2025.

1.4 Traffic management

Coordinating work

Key roads for HGV routes for Align are the A413/ A355/ A40/ M40 and M25 between the North Portal and the South Portal.

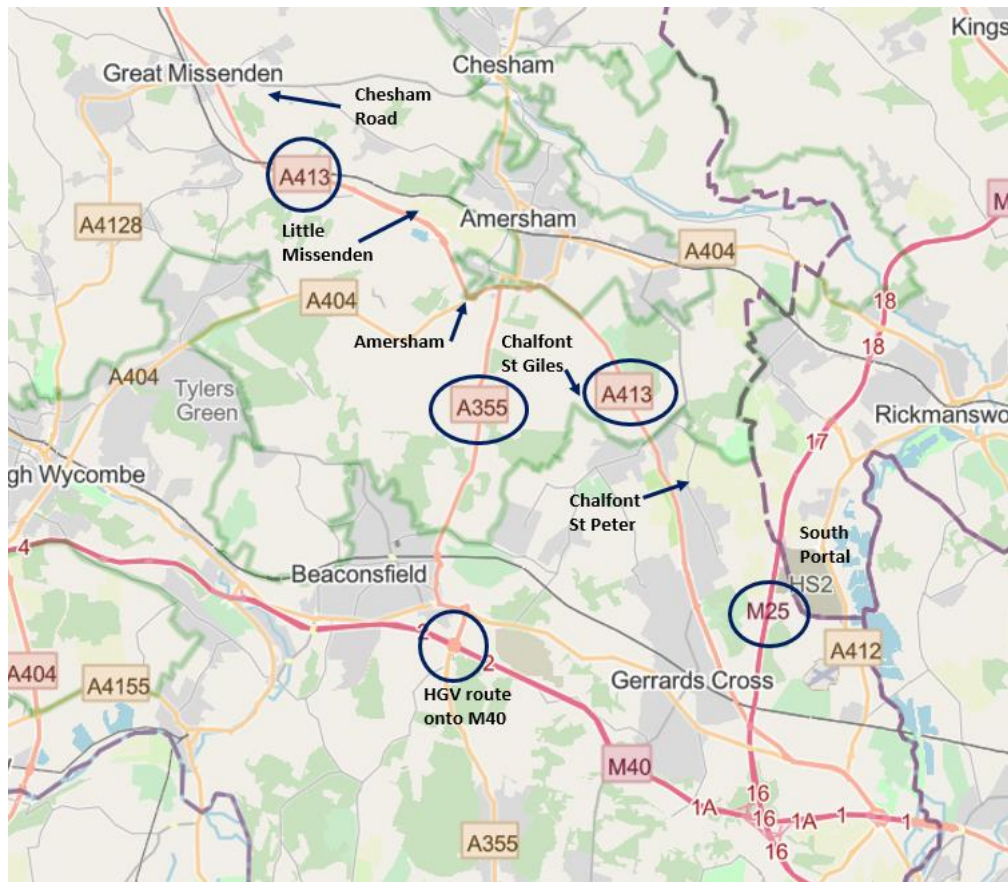
Traffic meetings take place monthly and involve traffic specialists from HS2 Ltd, contractors, emergency services and highway authority, Buckinghamshire Council, to coordinate traffic plans. Buckinghamshire Council have been in receipt of the Align Local Traffic Management Plan (LTMP) since October 2022 and receive an updated copy annually. As part of the Align LTMP these mitigations are in place:

1. Construction traffic use of the haul road to access the Chiltern Tunnel North Portal area
2. Construction of a temporary access road for the Chalfont St Peter shaft site avoids HGVs going through the village
3. To help us control the movement of HGV traffic heading to the vent shaft sites at Chalfont St Peter and Chalfont St Giles we have a lorry holding area off the A413 near Gerrards Cross. This allows us to avoid putting HGVs on the highway during peak periods where possible, and ensures we do not send too many HGVs to the sites all at once
4. We have built a Construction Consolidation Centre (CCC) at the South Portal. This means we have one central hub to manage all the deliveries out to our sites, so that they go on full loaded vehicles to cut down on the number of vehicle trips
5. We have built dedicated slip roads on the M25 for our HGVs to go to and from our main site at the South Portal.

Align and EKFB have now published a user-friendly version of the LTMP called a Traffic Guide. This is updated monthly and is distributed to all interested stakeholders in and around works sites in Buckinghamshire. These are also available at our local drop in events.

Align have kept Public Right of Way (PROW) long term diversions to a minimum, however there are diversions at each vent shaft site. Although not a PROW, the informal public access across the Amersham shaft site has been permanently moved to run around the side of the site, along with new provision for cyclists. Where PROWs are permanently diverted at Chesham Road and Little Missenden these will be kept as much as possible to their original alignment.

Approved HGV or access routes for HS2:



At the Chalfont St Peter and Chalfont St Giles vent shaft sites the approved route is M25/ M40/ A40 and A413. At Amersham, Little Missenden and the North Portal it is M25/ M40/ A40 and A355. At Chesham Road it is M25/ M40/ A40/ A413 and B485.

The HS2 Act of Parliament provides HS2 Ltd and their contractors with the powers to work in the highway to construct the new railway. The responsibilities that councils have for HS2 works differ slightly from other highway works. In all cases, the local Highway Authority is consulted and in certain cases, the consent of the highway authority is required. HS2 Ltd and their contractors produce Local Traffic Management Plans and work very closely with the councils and their highways teams to ensure that traffic is well managed. HS2 Ltd is only required to seek consent on traffic routes for vehicles over 7.5 tonnes.

1.5 Sensitive locations

An overview of any sensitive locations impacted by the works includes:

- public space, including regional parks and Areas of Outstanding Natural Beauty
- businesses
- community facilities

- sensitive receptors identified in the Local Environmental Management Plans such as those related to noise or air quality.

Having listened to local communities and resident groups we know that the main construction concerns continue to be dust, construction noise, increase in vehicles, the impact of traffic management and impact on the chalk aquifer. The main issues and stakeholders vary depending on the works location throughout the Chilterns. Residents and businesses will be likely to remain concerned about the potential for ground movement in and around the line of route of the tunnel for many years. HS2 Ltd has resources to monitor and provide information on ground settlement into the lifetime of the operational railway and we will signpost stakeholders who may be concerned to these resources via the HS2 Helpdesk.

Prior to starting works, which we assess as having a significant or notable impact (either physical, audible, or visual), we will ensure that there will be a two-week period of notice given to residents and key stakeholders for any activities taking place in the local area. HS2 Ltd are notified two weeks prior to that to review and approve any correspondence that we propose to send to residents.

Areas of sensitivity include:

Worksite	Type of work	Sensitive stakeholders
Chalfont St Peter	Headhouse construction, landscaping and continuation of use of temporary access road	Residents within 200 metres of the shaft site directly impacted, indirectly residents living near to the temporary access road; road users on the A413/A40/M40 and M25 who may be forced to use alternative routes or have journey times impacted. Interested stakeholders include the Chiltern Society; Chalfont St Peter and Chalfont St Giles Parish Councils; local Buckinghamshire Cllrs; Buckinghamshire Council staff, including EHO; AONB panel; Epilepsy Society; Robertswood School; Montessori Nursery; Woodland Care Home
Chalfont St Giles	Headhouse construction and landscaping and removal of temporary access road.	Farmer and family living adjacent to the site; residents of Bottom House Farm Lane including car storage business, indirectly residents living near to the temporary access road; road users on the A413/A40/M40 and M25 who may be forced to use alternative routes or have journey times impacted. Interested stakeholders include the Chiltern Society; Chalfont St Giles Parish and Amersham Town Council;

		Amersham Action Group; local Buckinghamshire Cllrs; Buckinghamshire Council staff, including EHO; AONB panel
Amersham	Excavation of the shaft; shallow basement piling; shaft internal structures; headhouse construction and landscaping.	Residents of Whielden Street and Fieldway; road users on the A413/A355/A40/M40 and M25 who may be forced to use alternative routes or have journey times impacted. Interested stakeholders include the Chiltern Society; and Amersham Town Council; Coleshill Parish Council; Amersham Action Group; Amersham Hospital; Chiltern Crematorium; local Buckinghamshire Cllrs; Buckinghamshire Council staff, including EHO; AONB panel; Shardeloes Estate
Little Missenden	Shaft internal structures; headhouse excavation / construction and landscaping.	Residents of Little Missenden; residents of Hyde Heath; Little Missenden Primary School; Hyde Heath Primary School; road users on the A413/A355/A40/M40 and M25 who may be forced to use alternative routes or have journey times impacted. Interested stakeholders include LMPC, the Chiltern Society; and Amersham Town Council; Amersham Action Group; Chiltern Hospital; local Buckinghamshire Cllrs; Buckinghamshire Council staff, including EHO; AONB panel; Shardeloes Estate
Chesham Road	Shaft internal structures; headhouse construction and landscaping.	Residents of South Heath and a property adjacent to the site (Meadow Leigh); Hyde Heath; Hyde Heath Primary School; road users on the A413/A355/A40/M40 and M25 who may be forced to use alternative routes or have journey times impacted. Interested stakeholders include the Chiltern Society; The Lee Parish Council; Gt Missenden Parish Council; Hyde Heath Village Society; GMVA, local Buckinghamshire Cllrs; Buckinghamshire Council staff, including EHO; AONB panel; Chesham Town Council
North Portal	Portal building construction, construction of batching plant, ancillary building and	Residents of South Heath; residents of Gt Missenden; road users on the A413/A355/A40/M40 and M25 who may be forced to use alternative routes or have journey times impacted. Interested stakeholders include the Chiltern Society; GMVA, The Lee Parish

	landscaping. Future road closures on Frith Hill, 24/7 working for TBM dismantling	Council; Gt Missenden Parish Council; local Buckinghamshire Cllrs; Buckinghamshire Council staff, including EHO; AONB panel
Cross Passages	Excavation of 38 cross passages (part of the permanent design of the tunnel, noise of excavation, and undermining of property	Residents living directly above or within a short distance of the cross passages in the Chiltern Tunnel, local Buckinghamshire Cllrs

1.6 Undertakings and assurances

A review of the Register of Undertakings and Assurances has been carried out and this was used to:

- Identify issues and areas of concern that will shape engagement activity
- Inform any messaging or communications, for example by acknowledging assurances already made on design
- Identify any commitments made regarding engagement with stakeholders on the design and construction of the Chiltern Tunnel and North Portal such as Assurance 1969 relating to notification of Woodland Trust in advance of any works within 100m of Ancient Woodland.

Commitment compliance plans have been drafted for all relevant U&As and evidence collection has commenced. When compliance is challenged by stakeholders, Align will work with the HS2 compliance team to undertake any necessary investigations and actions to ensure compliance.

The full list of Community Engagement U&As is included in Appendix E.

2 Engagement objectives

How we will engage

We are committed to engaging with our local communities, and have developed our engagement objectives, in line with the HS2 Community Engagement Strategy. We will use three types of engagement:

1. Informing – keeping communities informed on the issues that affect them through clear, timely and tailored communications
2. Involving – creating opportunities for local communities to get involved throughout the design and delivery so that we take into consideration how they live, work and play
3. Responding – providing free and accessible options for communities to contact us to seek information and raise their concerns. Responding to requests and comments in a timely and comprehensive way.

Our engagement objectives

Engagement objectives	Type of engagement	Key activity and measure
Coordinate closely with colleague managing engagement in C1N to ensure that communications are consistent across work areas	Inform, involve and respond	To publish newsletters, conduct meetings with parish councils, hold drop-ins to inform local stakeholders of changes. Four newsletters published in a year.
Complete three-month lookaheads for each shaft site explaining works along the Chiltern Tunnel route	Inform and involve	To publish construction lookaheads for each key programme stage Four lookaheads in a year.
To build strong and effective relationships with community leaders to facilitate communication and to engage with under-represented groups sections of the community	Inform, involve and respond	Maintain regular meetings with identified key parish councils, resident associations, village societies, governing bodies and other interested parties. 4-6 weekly meetings with resident associations, parish councils, individual councillors. Mobilise Social Value at meetings to reach other groups and residents that have not previously been in communication with us.

Invite stakeholders to our sites, meet technical team members and talk them through our works	Inform	To facilitate shaft site /portal tours with relevant community stakeholders to improve awareness of works and reasons for certain impacts. Aiming for 1 site visit per month
To facilitate visits to the South Portal, vent shaft sites, and North Portal as required	Inform	Encourage visitor centre tours with community representatives, schools, members of the public and organisations with similar/specialist interest in the works. Aiming for one per month
Allow appropriate time for engagement and notification of works and ensure that appropriate audience reach is considered when communicating works impacts	Inform	To publish AWNs two weeks ahead of works that will have significant impact on residents and stakeholders and submit to HS2 two weeks in advance for review. Details will include: • A map of the area • Timescales • Explanation of works • HS2 helpdesk details
Work collaboratively with EKFB in our delivery of information, providing efficient engagement by both main works contractors simultaneously	Respond	Attend joint meetings together and be present. Sharing learned knowledge, plans and impacts from other contractors with our production teams. Stakeholders benefit from both MWC in the same meeting
To work collaboratively with local stakeholders including local authority/parish	Inform and involve	Attend regular meetings where we will deliver:

councillors to support communication of works and community investment opportunities		• AWNs • forward looks • investment initiatives • update of enquiries • good news stories • offer site visits
Work collaboratively with the HS2 Public Response Manager to meet both KPI response rates by: • attending areas to investigate where necessary • source information from production, delivery and specialist teams • research the history • contact the complainant to gain knowledge where required	Respond and inform	Efficient response to all complaints and enquiries

Engagement principles

Our objectives will be delivered using core principles to ensure that our engagement is conducted with integrity and that the process is efficient and effective. These eight principles have informed our programme from the start and define our engagement approach:

- Transparency – engagement will always provide open and honest communication
- Timeliness – communication will occur at the right time, at suitable points in the programme, ensuring that communities remain informed
- Relevance – we will prioritise information which is applicable to the local area and wider information will be presented in a way to highlight elements or issues of particular importance at the local level
- Targeted – communications will consider the audiences for which it is intended and will provide information in styles and formats through channels that are appropriate and accessible

- Reflective – communications will be adapted to reflect and react to concerns which arise, tailoring engagement and information to the needs of communities
- Effective – our engagement will be measured and assessed to ensure activity is responding to communities needs
- Ongoing – engagement and communication will be undertaken regularly to ensure constant dialogue and to minimise rumours and lies
- No surprises – we will ensure statutory stakeholders receive information before wider publication and that communities are informed before works take place.

3 Stakeholder mapping

Stakeholder mapping and audience research has been carried out and can be found as evidenced in a sample of the Stakeholder Tracker in Appendix A.

Engagement will be achieved in partnership with EKFB regularly by attending:

- joint meetings
- joint drop-in sessions
- joint KDE events where both contractors are present for support
- joint site meetings/ tours

We plan, host and deliver engagement collaboratively with EKFB which means that our knowledge of shared stakeholders very high. We communicate regularly on any key issues and the lead contractor for any given circumstance will keep the other updated so that our respective stakeholder mas can be kept up to date.

Our level of engagement with the individual stakeholders or groups will be informed by our understanding of their level of interest and influence, as illustrated below in the assessment and summary plan for the key stakeholders in the Chiltern Tunnel Area:

Stakeholder	Engagement style and frequency	Future engagement
Buckinghamshire Council	Select Committee appearances, regular telephone calls, emails, liaison through dedicated council liaison officers, regular meeting attendance	Planning applications (incl. S61), visits, invitations to key milestone achievements
Chiltern Society	Regular telephone calls, emails, meetings and site visits where the society captures and publishes photographs of site activity	Continuation of site visits, photo opportunities and invitations to key milestone achievements, including looking at longer term

		opportunities to contribute to local records of the project and facilitating discussions with the Chiltern Society about the future of the railway in the area and its relationship with the land
Great Missenden Village Association	Monthly teams meeting, regular emails and occasional site visits	Involve with community initiatives and ideas, including footpath improvements and local volunteering opportunities
Great Missenden Parish Council	Regular phone calls, emails, meetings and site visits	Continuation of site visits, invitations to key milestone achievements and inclusion of section 61 discussions
The Lee Parish Council	Regular phone calls, emails, meetings and site visits	Continuation of site visits, invitations to key milestone achievements and include in traffic data monitoring ideas
Hyde End Residents Group	Monthly teams meeting	Involve with community initiatives and ideas
The Chiltern Conservation Board	Monthly teams meeting	Involve with environmental suggestions
Chesham Town Council / Councillor Jane MacBean	Regular phone calls, Teams meetings and site visits	Continuation of site visits, invitations to key milestone achievements and inclusion of community investment ideas
Councillor Peter Martin, Cabinet Member for Transport and HS2	Regular phone calls, Teams meetings and site visits	Continuation of site visits, invitations to key milestone achievements, inclusion of community investment ideas and discussions of section 61 arrangements

Councillor Patricia Birchley	Regular Teams meetings and occasional site visits	Invite to the South Portal visitor centre, key milestone achievements and recommendations of engaging with new community groups
Hyde Heath Village Society (Andy Cordiner)	Regular Teams meetings and occasional site visits	Invite to the South Portal visitor centre, key milestone achievements and discussions of section 61 arrangements
Graeme Wilson	Regular phone calls and in person meetings	U&A in place regarding access to his shooting range
Farmer at Bottom House Farm Lane	Regular phone calls and in person meetings	Regular updates required leading up to the annual compensation payments and works along BHFL and other
Amersham Town Council	Monthly Teams meeting	Invite different specialists / HS2 to provide updates at meetings, invite to site visits and key milestone achievement events
Little Missenden Parish Council	Two monthly Teams meetings, occasional phone call and in person meeting	Discussions of section 61 arrangements, involve with community initiatives and ideas. Invite different specialists / HS2 to provide updates at meetings
Resident at Elm Cottage	Regular email updates for site activity, formal emails with ongoing complaints tracker, occasional in person meeting	Continue to update on site activity / change, work collaboratively with Buckinghamshire Council to resolve any issues and share good news where possible, such as litter picks.

		Correspondence with stakeholder is through HS2
The Misbourne School	AWNs, emails of impacts	Continue to engage with the school to the South Portal Visitor Centre, inform them of apprentice opportunities and offer site visits to NP
Great Missenden Cof E School	AWNs, emails of impacts	Continue to engage with the school to the South Portal Visitor Centre, involve them in any initiatives / designs that may be possible, investigate social value opportunities

Appendix A provides a matrix of key stakeholder interest and influence across the whole of C1. This is reviewed and updated quarterly.

Business mapping has been carried out and will be used to inform and guide our direct communications with local businesses with regards to potential impacts of works, particularly road closures.

The below table provides a general overview of the key stakeholders:

Site	Residents	Stakeholders
Chalfont St Peter	All those living with 200m of the site and those living on A413 and local roads which will still see non-HGV Align vehicles use them	Parish council; Chiltern Society; Buckinghamshire Council; Environment Agency; Affinity Water, Chiltern Conservation Board
Chalfont St Giles	All those living with 200m of the site and those living on A413 and local roads which will still see non-HGV Align vehicles use them	Parish council; Chiltern Society; Buckinghamshire Council; Environment Agency; Affinity Water, Chiltern Conservation Board
Amersham	All those living with 200m of the site and those living on A413/A355 and local roads	Amersham Action Group; Town Council; Coleshill Parish Council; Chiltern

	which will still see non-HGV Align vehicles use them	Society; Buckinghamshire Council; Environment Agency; Affinity Water; Amersham Hospital; Chiltern Crematorium, Chiltern Conservation Board, UKPN
Little Missenden	All those living with 200m of the site and those living on A413 and local roads which will still see non-HGV Align vehicles use them	Parish council; Hyde Heath Village Society; primary schools; Chiltern Society; Buckinghamshire Council; Environment Agency; Affinity Water; Amersham Hospital; Chiltern Hospital, Chiltern Conservation Board, UKPN
Chesham Road	All those living with 200m of the site and those living on B485 and A413 and local roads which will still see non-HGV Align vehicles use them	Parish councils; Chiltern Society; Buckinghamshire Council; Environment Agency; Affinity Water, Chiltern Conservation Board, Hyde End Residents Group, UKPN
North Portal	All those living with 200m of the site and those living on A413 and local roads which will still see non-HGV Align vehicles use them	Parish councils; Chiltern Society; Buckinghamshire Council; Environment Agency; Affinity Water, Chiltern Conservation Board, Great Missenden Village Association, UKPN

4 Issues analysis

An ongoing assessment of issues which emerge through our engagement interaction with stakeholders, communities and residents helps to identify any areas where we can improve our response to concerns or prevent issues through information sharing. Stakeholder and site profiles will be updated on a regular basis and key issues will be identified as a result.

A broad issues summary has been included in Appendix B which details the known and predicted concerns that we engage on for each specific site.

Complaints and enquiries information and analysis of SRM records is used to inform engagement and communication planning of wider trends or issues on a site-by-site basis.

Site Specific Environmental Analysis

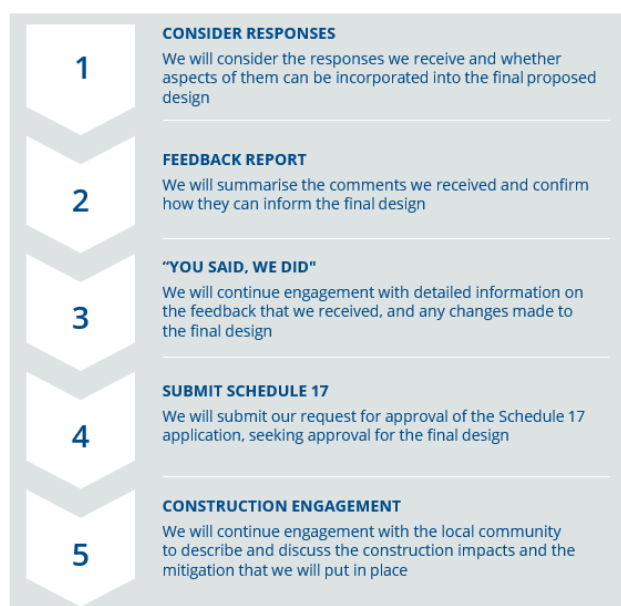
In addition to maintaining and reporting on issues, the Community Engagement team has a reporting function to raise concerns or issues to the environment team, in line with the following Site-Specific Environment Management Plans for the Chiltern Tunnel:

- Chalfont St Giles Site-Specific Environmental Management Plan
- Chalfont St Peter Site-Site Specific Environmental Management Plan
- Amersham Vent Shaft Site-Specific Environmental Management Plan
- Little Missenden Vent Shaft Site-Specific Environmental Management Plan
- Chesham Road Shaft Site-Specific Environmental Management Plan
- North Portal Shaft Site-Specific Environmental Management Plan

Further information on the environmental sensitivities for each of these sites is published in these plans.

5 Channels and tactics

We follow the principles below in the KDE elements of our programme, ensuring that the communities living near to the key components of the Chiltern Tunnel have had the opportunity to engage with the proposals and record their feedback to the designs.



Key Design Element Engagement Process

Having completed our Key Design Element applications and engagement on the designs of the headhouses and landscaping in C1 in March 2023 with the North Portal KDE event, we are fully engaged in providing regular construction updates as the mainstay of our engagement programme.

The focus will now shift to providing updates on the progress of key construction milestones and maintaining a proactive approach to resolving local concerns and issues regarding construction impacts. The key milestones that have been flagged in the site-specific analysis at the start of this document will form the basis for this engagement activity.

Key stakeholders

Key stakeholders have been identified initially using a review of previous engagement and then ongoing through engagement activity. These individuals or groups are those who represent critical interests or communities.

The stakeholders will form a route through which to communicate, engage and gather feedback. They will also provide additional channels or routes to sub-sections of the audience.

These groups include local planning authorities, parish councils, community leaders, action group leaders and representative of impacted areas or businesses.

Two-way engagement

We will continue to ensure, through liaison with HS2, that digital versions of any written notifications are available for ease of access and AWNs can be accessed via an interactive map at HS2's "In your Area" website.

By garnering feedback and using it to inform engagement as appropriate, reviewing the effectiveness and feedback from previous engagement activity in the area in collaboration with, for example the EWC and local authorities, we identify the most effective channels for the specific area and audience. Face to face contact however, such as "door-knocking", scheduled meetings, or site visits remain as the best opportunity to engage directly. This also has the benefit of reducing paper correspondence.

We will encourage direct email correspondence and discussion when responding to enquiries to reduce printed correspondence.

We will use established contacts and relationships within local authorities to ensure that the appropriate channels are pursued to resolve any issues raised.

Ensuring accessibility and inclusivity

All engagement and communication will continue to consider accessibility and inclusivity, in line with standard principles and guidance noted in the HS2 Community Engagement Strategy Framework and any other pertinent documentation, for example on website accessibility, translation services or document formats.

In addition, we will continue to use our experience and analysis of local demographics to identify measures specific to the local area that may be required. This analysis will be supplemented by engagement with representatives of those groups, such as community leaders or local organisations to seek assurance on the preferred and most effective routes for communications. This may include presentation of messages in appropriate languages, or provision for groups with accessibility needs who are represented in the community.

Online

We use MS Teams meetings and webinars to engage with residents and stakeholders' groups on a regular basis where drop ins may not be convenient or practical. Webinars are also used to reach out to communities and interested groups and will continue to be used in conjunction with face-to-face events to keep the wider public fully informed.

Social media

We follow HS2 Ltd's Social Media Policy on corporate social media channels but will look at the potential for using social media platforms such as Twitter and Facebook to disseminate information during phase 2, in particular 'live' information such as notification of short-term disruption or information about events. All digital content will be agreed with HS2 Ltd.

We are not active on any social media channels, apart from LinkedIn to support our recruitment activities and mark key Align milestones.

Where appropriate and with agreement from HS2, Awns and related information will be shared via social media. This will generally be for high profile and wide impacting works e.g. A413 road closure.

Media

All media enquiries are referred to HS2 Ltd's press office. In agreement with the press office statements or interviews may also be offered at key points in the programme, or where ad hoc issues arise. No press or media releases will be issued directly by Align. Media training will be provided where necessary to discuss HS2 Ltd protocol.

Community routes

Online (such as local websites) or in hardcopy (such as community information boards) community networks have been used as a route to share information and will continue to be employed.

Public exhibitions and community hubs

Using information stands, public exhibitions and community hubs we can inform, involve and respond, providing information about forthcoming elements of the project. Engagement at this level achieves greater understanding of and buy-in to the construction process by local communities and stakeholders, resulting in an enhanced reputation for HS2.

Align is responsible for arranging the events which comprises the following tasks:

- Selection of venues, booking arrangements
- Health and safety checks and risk assessments on new or unused venues
- Event resource planning and attendance
- Awareness raising
- Staff handbook/FAQs
- Event logistics planning.

We will continue to produce a set of FAQs and distribute them to the team for events. The team staffing the events will continue to be invited to a briefing prior to the event start.

This will cover a health and safety briefing which will be venue specific and a discussion of ‘lines to take’ on all prior discussed potential questions that may be asked by the public for new staff.

The project team, including HS2 representatives, should be on hand to answer queries the public may have.

Materials for the events will include but are not limited to formal exhibitions boards and leaflets, screens, animations or videos, AO size maps and VR. We will continue to use feedback forms for all engagement channels and follow the format of the standardised Community Survey.

As a result, questions and responses will be informed by HS2 community commitments and project KPIs. Feedback forms are made available at events and through QR codes linking to online forms.

Responses received through engagement events will be processed and analysed and will help to provide feedback and improvements for subsequent engagement activity.

Residents’ groups and community meetings

We will be continuing the work to strengthen relationships with residents’ groups and parish council representatives by continued representation at meetings. Examples of these include:

- Regular meetings with the Amersham Action Group – a community group representing anti HS2 group, Amersham Town Council, Chiltern Society, Amersham Hospital and local businesses
- Regular meetings with Chiltern Society
- Regular meetings with Chalfont St Peter, Chalfont St Giles, Coleshill, Little Missenden, Gt Missenden and The Lee Parish Councils
- Coordination of meetings with C1N engagement manager to ensure that meetings near the C1 and C1N boundary are appropriately managed.

Venue selection

The selection of venues for public exhibitions, community hubs, ad hoc meetings with residents and community groups alike will continue to be informed by the sensitive areas identified and taking on board stakeholder feedback. In agreement with HS2 Ltd we recommend the following key criteria to be considered when selecting each venue:

- provision of disabled access for members of the public
- toilet facilities appropriate for members of the public
- suitably sized venue appropriate to the estimated population of attendees
- reasonable cost to the taxpayer, to represent value for money
- suitable sized car park
- public transport links
- provision of tables and chairs to facilitate discussions with attendees
- feasibility to assemble projector screens and display boards within the given space.

If it were not possible to satisfy all these criteria due to the remote nature of the programme area, a proportionate approach to the selection of the venue will be taken.

We would also aim to involve local Parish Councils and communities in the decision on the location of events to try and ensure they are involved.

Newsletters

Subject to HS2 Ltd's requirements we will contribute to the production and distribution of online and hardcopy community newsletters. Contribution will follow HS2 Ltd's branding guidelines and media protocol. The newsletters will provide updates on the project and provide information about forthcoming activity. Consideration will be given to newsletters tailored to audiences, for example local businesses, where this is expected to deliver additional benefits.

We will also work with Buckinghamshire Council and local community groups to share information through their established channels and forums.

Mail distribution

Ahead of significant project activities, particularly those likely to have direct impacts on areas, we will continue to undertake a direct mailing to those likely to be impacted. In agreement with

HS2 Ltd, the content will be reviewed and distributed at least two weeks before the described works are carried out. An additional two-week lead-in time is required for HS2 Ltd's Community Engagement Manager to review the detail of the notification.

Public Affairs

Contact with the local MPs and councillors will be sought and, where appropriate, specific engagement approaches will be put in place, such as pre-briefings or forum sessions to provide information. Attendance would be agreed with HS2 Ltd in advance and written invitations distributed.

Site visits

Contact with residents' groups and community groups over the years has created a **now well-established** interest in visiting **sites** and works behind the hoardings. This continues to be a very valuable mode of engagement. We will continue to openly publicise the possibility of attending the South Portal visitors centre, the North Portal, or select ventilation shaft sites, by invitation to interested parties and residents at our community events and **scheduled meetings**.

Programmes

Programmes and timetables for planned engagement will be kept under review and used to inform our engagement plan. We will continue to ensure that there will be a defined period of notice given to stakeholders for any activities taking place in the local area.

6 Messaging

The current Align JV project messaging has been updated in agreement with HS2 Ltd. We will continue to ensure that the message remains consistent and work closely with other contractors in phase 1 to align messaging at the cross over points with EKFB in C2 and with the other MWCC through regular collaboration and attendance at shared events and **meetings**.

Messaging will continue to reflect that used in other engagement plans and documents, to ensure consistency across the project, through engagement with plan owners. For example:

- We aim to meet our planned working dates, but **these can be subject to change**
- We will do all we can to keep you updated
- Road diversions will be fully signed and in place
- The HS2 helpdesk is available 24/7

This messaging will continue to form part of the Q&A documentation, which will be issued and used by all staff working on the Main Works Contract, including corporate helpdesks.

6.1 The Chiltern Tunnel key messages

Chiltern Tunnel key messages

- The Chiltern Tunnel is the longest tunnel on the HS2 route. It is 16km (10 miles) long and runs from the South Portal at West Hyde (near Rickmansworth) and will carry passengers under the Chiltern Hills to the North Portal at South Heath (near Great Missenden)
- The twin-bore Chiltern Tunnel **was** excavated by two Tunnel Boring Machines (TBMs) – Florence and Cecilia – which were launched in summer 2021 and exited at Great Missenden in February and May 2024, respectively
- The two TBMs **were** designed specifically for the geology of the Chilterns. They **excavated** approximately 2.7 million cubic metres of chalk material which **was** compressed and dried at our South Portal site. Once construction is complete the dried chalk will help create around 90 hectares of wildlife-rich chalk grassland habitats. Chalk grassland used to be widespread across the hills of southeast England and are considered habitats of international conservation significance with just 700ha left across the Chilterns.
- The TBMs **finished** their journey at the North Portal in Q1 of 2024 where they **were** disassembled and removed in pieces.

Cross passage key messages

- The twin-bore Chiltern tunnel has 38 cross passages that link the northbound and southbound tunnel. Each passage is between 15 and 20 metres in length
- Work to begin excavating the cross passages started in summer 2022 by our team of miners who use a remotely controlled excavator to break out of and excavate from one running tunnel to the adjacent tunnel
- Once the passageway is complete, the safety doors can be installed at either end. Each running tunnel has an emergency walkway that allows passengers to safely evacuate the train and walk through the cross passages into the other tunnel where they can be rescued on a passenger train. Access for emergency services is from either the portal or one of the five ventilation/emergency access shafts.

Ventilation/ intervention shaft key messages

- The Chiltern Tunnel is connected to the surface and open air through five shafts – vertical openings – that regulate air quality and temperature in the tunnel and allows smoke to be extracted in the event of a fire
- We have four ventilation shafts located at Chalfont St Peter, Chalfont St Giles, Amersham and Little Missenden which also allow emergency services access in the event of an incident in the tunnel. These shafts are all constructed using a diaphragm wall.

- There is one intervention shaft along the Chiltern Tunnel, and this is located at Chesham Road. It is constructed using the caisson method and is to be used only to provide access for emergency services
- The headhouse is the building on top of the ventilation shaft which contains fire control systems and the ventilation systems for the railway tunnels below. Each headhouse building is a 'Key Design Element' and we have sought local authority planning consent for the design of all five headhouses.

Rail systems key messages

- The outfitting of rail and control systems on the nascent railway is becoming a more common topic of discussion at Align's meetings and public events with external stakeholders and will predictably become more of an issue of general interest as civils works in the Colne Valley and Chilterns near completion.
- Following the official announcement regarding the appointment of a rail systems contractor, Align JV will work with HS2 to signpost information for stakeholders at events and in communications, to guide them to the appropriate contractor's information.
- At the appropriate time we will welcome the opportunity to integrate rail systems information and personnel into our events. This will be closely coordinated with the appropriate contractor and HS2 Ltd will manage the interface with rail systems stakeholder engagement representatives.
- More information is to be expected on the roll-out of this information in subsequent months, and a more detailed outlook is to be expected in the next annual revision of the LAEPs for the Chiltern Tunnel and South Portal and Colne Valley Viaduct.
- Rail Systems refers to the many systems required for trains to run on a fully licensed operational railway. They include the track system, overhead catenary system, traction power (the electricity supply to the train), communications, depots and signalling.
- The Rail Systems contracts were awarded in Autumn 2024. There will now be a period of mobilisation, then detailed design before any works start on site. There will be a series of phased handovers from the main works contractors to the incoming Rail Systems contractors. We expect Rail Systems contractors to reach out to local communities about plans for their area once this stage of detail design is complete and before works begin on site.

Other key messages

- Rail Systems will acquire the railway line, headhouses, viaducts and all assets associated with the HS2 project, including its operation. We don't yet have a date for this.
- We will conduct our engagement with integrity, leadership, respect and safety. Listening to concerns, ideas, feedback and comments we can shape our engagement plans to target

those who need us the most. Our conversations and responses are mindful of our stakeholders' thoughts and opinions.

- By delivering and presenting our updated lookaheads, we will ensure to include: a progress update, upcoming works, community investment and social value, good news stories and HS2 opportunities.
- HS2's Arts and Culture strategy aims to make a positive contribution to the overall impact of the project's architecture and landscape along the route. It includes proposals for permanent art commissions which are intended to enrich the journeys of the rail passengers who use HS2. Numerous arts and culture projects are already engaged in communities along the route. Align JV will support the communication of any projects in Area C1 through discussion with stakeholders and events which signpost stakeholders to HS2's programme and further information on how to get involved.

7 Action plan

This overall action plan will also be supplemented by the three-month forward look of engagement activity, which is used to track and report progress to the HS2 Ltd Community & Stakeholder Engagement team, and by individual engagement plans for key design elements.

7.1 Construction Milestone and Update Engagement 2025

Chiltern Tunnel Vent shaft milestones

Activity / milestone	Date	Engagement
Planned Completion Date for Chiltern Tunnel Handover for Tunnel portals and Chiltern Tunnel	June 2025 July 2025	Land handback discussions Newsletter?
Chalfont St Peter Planned completion without MEP Safe stopping prior to RS Handover - complete Demobilisation Handover Key date – Expected Descoped or unresolved MEP Access to field/hedge line TAR	July August August March 2026	Regular meetings with Chiltern Society, Chiltern Conservation Board. Information to be sent CSP Parish Council. AWN, Community Events TBC
Chalfont St Giles Land handback Safe stopping prior to RS Handover Planned completion without MEP Demobilisation Handover Key date – Expected Descoped or unresolved MEP TAR and junction design (A412/BHFL)	Ongoing August July August April 2026	1.1 engagement with landowner Regular meetings with Chiltern Society, Chiltern Conservation Board. Information sent CGP Parish Council. AWN Community Events TBC

Vent shaft milestones

Activity / milestone	E	Engagement
Amersham Flint wall – complete Cladding- complete AMSs gate – complete Planned completion without MEP - complete Safe stopping prior to RS Handover - complete Demobilisation – complete Key Handover date – Expected Descoped or unresolved MEP	July August August September November December April 2026	Regular meetings with Chiltern Society, Chiltern Conservation Board, Amersham Action Group, Amersham Stakeholder Group,, Amersham Town Council, Bucks officers, AWN, Community Events TBC
Little Missenden Planned completion without MEP Landscape - complete Safe stopping prior to RS Handover - complete Demobilisation Key Handover date – Expected Descoped or unresolved MEP	August August September September September	Regular meetings with Chiltern Society, Chiltern Conservation Board, Amersham Action Group, Amersham Stakeholder Group, AWN, Community Events TBC

Vent shaft milestones

Activity / milestone	Date	Engagement
Chesham Road Land handback Planned completion without MEP - complete Safe stopping prior to RS Handover – complete Landscaping – complete Demobilisation – complete Handover Key date – Expected Descoped or unresolved MEP	Ongoing August September October November April 2026	1.1 engagement with landowners Regular meetings with Chiltern Society, Chiltern Conservation Board, Amersham Action Group, Amersham Stakeholder Group, AWN, Community Events TBC



8 Reactive communications

Our established process for receiving and responding to complaints and enquiries is for the Community Engagement team, through the dedicated Public Response Manager, to be the first point of contact to receive communications and manage the appropriate response.

Correspondence is managed using the Community Engagement inbox and SRM so that we offer a consistent response to all stakeholders.

As outlined in WI 875 that HS2 Ltd provides and operates a project helpdesk in accordance with Section 5.1 (Community Relations) of the Code of Construction Practice, and section 7 (Complaints and Enquiries) of the Community Engagement Framework. We work closely with the HS2 Helpdesk, as well as other contractors' public response teams, using SRM to ensure that all responses are issued within the specified KPI timeframes.

As agreed with HS2 Ltd, an escalation and clearance procedure has been put in place to ensure that all such communications are channelled through the appropriate approval process and that actions are delivered within the response times agreed with HS2 Ltd.

9 Measurement and evaluation

The basis of our engagement work is informed by HS2's ten Community Commitments and links to the KPI's and the community engagement matrix. An overview of how the specific objectives within this plan will be measured and evaluated is provided below:

- Feedback from events and engagement, providing a route for attendees to submit their assessment of the event in a simple format, potentially using a system to provide live and immediate feedback. Feedback forms would reflect the standardised engagement questionnaire/Community Survey.
- Records of number and quality of responses to surveys and KDE events.
- Records of distribution of materials and information, including numbers and types of materials provided.
- Website hits at virtual events such as Online Exhibitions, and webinar attendance, ticket bookings.
- Corporate helpdesk enquiries by telephone and email, including a comparison of volumes pre and post engagement activity.
- Equalities monitoring (via equalities questions in surveys).
- Media monitoring.

- Social media when used / webinar numbers.
- Feedback from the Insights report is due back in March 2023.
- Considerate Constructors awards, industry awards and feedback on community engagement
- Site assurance visits in conjunction with HS2 where we will be assessed on our actions and sharing of information

All feedback is collated and analysed at regular intervals. On a day-to-day basis all feedback and interactions with stakeholders and communities are recorded on SRM. Monthly audits will be undertaken to ensure that all engagement is being recorded and captured on SRM and this will also include a review to ensure that the following fields are completed as a minimum:

- Title of meeting
- Date
- Time
- Location
- No of attendees
- Names and job titles
- Meeting notes

Monthly reporting is undertaken using all in-month data that has been recorded on SRM. Monthly reports highlight the key issues that have been raised by communities and stakeholders and actions taken. This monthly report is shared with the client and internal stakeholders. On a quarterly basis we submit our PMU6 report that details and measures our engagement activity against KPIs. We aim to maintain 100% of our complaints and enquiries log, closing out all raised within the SLA 20 working days or 2 working days for urgent responses.

After community events and significant construction issues the team routinely undertake a 'lessons learned' exercise to capture best practice and to ensure that we take opportunities to improve and respond to feedback [and share learning with HS2](#). We will update our processes and ways of working to reflect this. Where we identify areas for improvement, we will share this across the team and IPT and, if applicable, with other MWCCs.

We also receive a quarterly "Insights" report from HS2 that provides us with a score and feedback from their 'mystery shopper' activities. We will use the feedback from Insights and work with the right teams across the JV to ensure that we are providing the best community interactions at all levels and seek to implement improvements where possible. We aim to be within the top 90% on our feedback.

10 Ways of working

10.1 Working with HS2 and others

We hold regular meetings across the integrated project team and with neighbouring contractors EKFB to resolve issues. Continuous engagement takes place between the HS2 interface and engagement staff members and the counterparts at Align. We will work together to identify potential challenges in advance and address them. Internal meetings are held at regular intervals across technical disciplines and other teams to ensure that communities remain at the heart of the work that Align undertakes.

Many utilities companies work in these areas on our behalf. We share our best practice with them in terms of lessons learned, areas of concern, expectations from residents, logistical recommendations, well known diversion routes, vulnerable people that may be affected, methods to reach them and work together to keep the community updated.

11 Challenges in 2025

There are a number of work streams and challenges that are currently out of the scope of the Align JV's contract to manage or administer, but which will need careful collaboration and strategic thinking to navigate in the next year.

Continuous engagement takes place between the HS2 interface and engagement staff members and the counterparts at Align, and our supply chain and we will work together to identify potential challenges in advance and address them. The following issues are the key items that we have identified as being of particular interest in the year to come:

11.1 Landscaping programme and site handover

Across all of our sites on C1 and C1N we are now actively preparing for the handover of the civils assets and works compounds. The first of these sites will be transferred to HS2 in spring 2025 but at the time of writing the works programme is still to be progressed to a sufficient stage where any of the sites can be fully handed over.

We will be working more closely than ever with local authorities, the Land team and HS2, to ensure that communications with stakeholders, residents and land owners are managed to facilitate an efficient handback or transition to new contractor, client or owner.

11.2 Railway systems integration and handover

We are increasingly asked at public events about the works packages that will be awarded after the mains civils contract on C1 and C1N are complete. The most common questions that need

to be addressed by the incoming contractor in the public forum are logistics, communications masts at sites, catenary, working hours and noise, and requirements for the electrification of the train line.

At the time of writing there is very little publically available information to address “what comes next”, including the details of the incoming contractor and our respective counterparts in their organisations.

We expect to begin preparing “knowledge packs” and community engagement briefings in order to provide a legacy of information for any incoming contractor beginning early in 2025.

11.3 Political change

We do not expect any wholesale change to the C1 or C1N scope of works in the remaining course of the Align contract, however, there are some imminent changes to local government which require close and careful management to ensure that our civils programme continues unhindered in 2025 and beyond:

January 2025 – London Borough of Hillingdon Leadership change

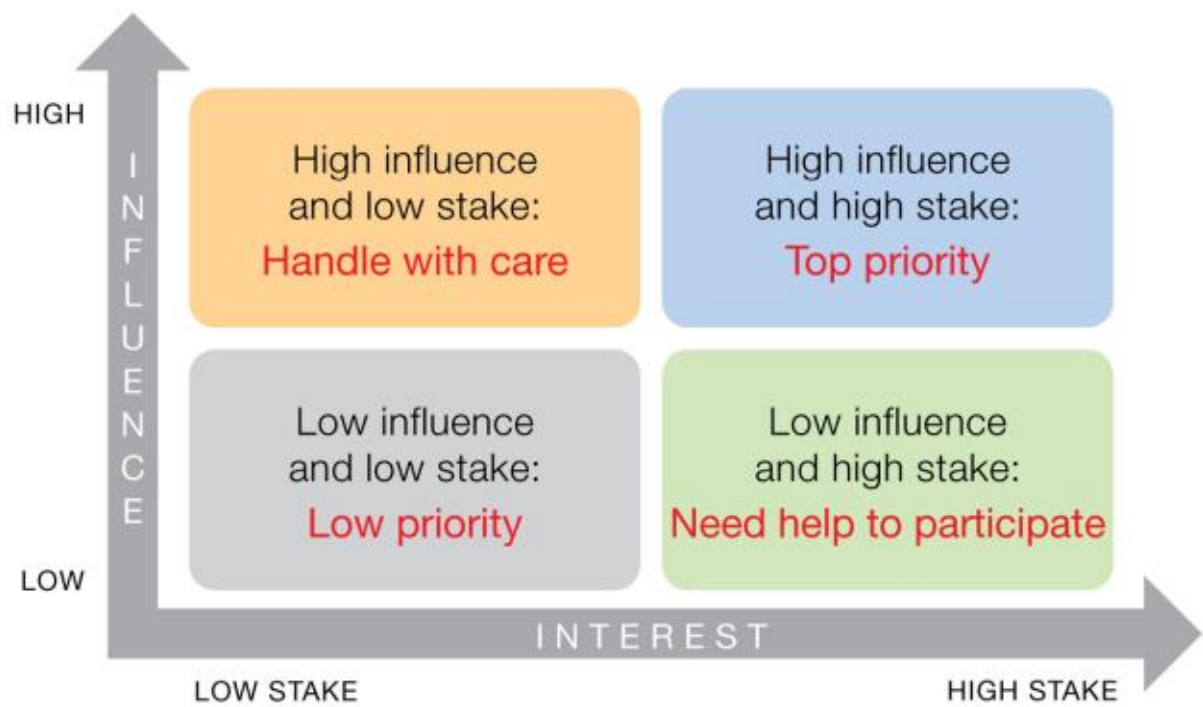
May 2025 - Unitary elections in Buckinghamshire

May 2025 – One third of seats in Three Rivers District Council elected

Appendices

Appendix A

Matrix of stakeholder interest and Influence



	Charities	Community facilities	Education	Environmental	HS2/other contractors	Local authorities
Tier 1: Stakeholders/ organisations who are significantly impacted by, or have a critical influence on the project	Dogs Trust West London			Chilterns AONB Review Group Environment Agency	EKFB SCS	Buckinghamshire Council Hertfordshire County Council London Borough of Hillingdon Cllr Peter Martin Cllr Jane MacBean Three Rivers District Council Cllr Paula Hiscocks
Tier 2: Those stakeholders who are impacted by, or who may have influence or interest in the project	Action for Children Epilepsy Society	Amersham Hospital Hillingdon Outdoor Activity Centre	Brunel University Reach Free School	Colne Valley Regional Park Herts & Middx Wildlife Trust Woodland Trust Chiltern Conservation Board (CCB) The Chiltern Society	BBV	Cllr Steve Broadbent Cllr Guy Hollis Cllr Patricia Birchley Cllr Jane Palmer Cllr Simon Rouse Cllr Timothy Butcher Cllr Carl Jackson Cllr Mark Roberts Cllr Mark Flys
Tier 3: Wider stakeholders who have a limited interest and there is little or no engagement	Chalfont St Giles food bank Crisis in Hillingdon Woodoaks Farm (Soil Association) Bucks Search and Rescue	Chiltern Hospital Chiltern Open Air Museum Harefield Hospital The Harefield Surgery Harefield Football Club St Thomas Church – West Hyde West Hyde Youth Club Northolt Boxing Club The Bucks Community Take Out Chorleywood Youth Football Club Roald Dahl Museum Maple Cross Club	Robertswood School Chalfont St Peter Academy Little Missenden Infants School Hyde Heath School Maple Cross School Uxbridge College Doctor Challoners Grammar School Chorleywood Primary School Gt Missenden CofE School The Misbourne School	Ramblers Society River Chess Association Misbourne Environment Protection Group	Ecosoulis Socotec Instalcom Mace Dragados Skanska	Cllr Santokh Chhokar Cllr Isobel Derby Cllr Phil Williams Cllr John Hensley

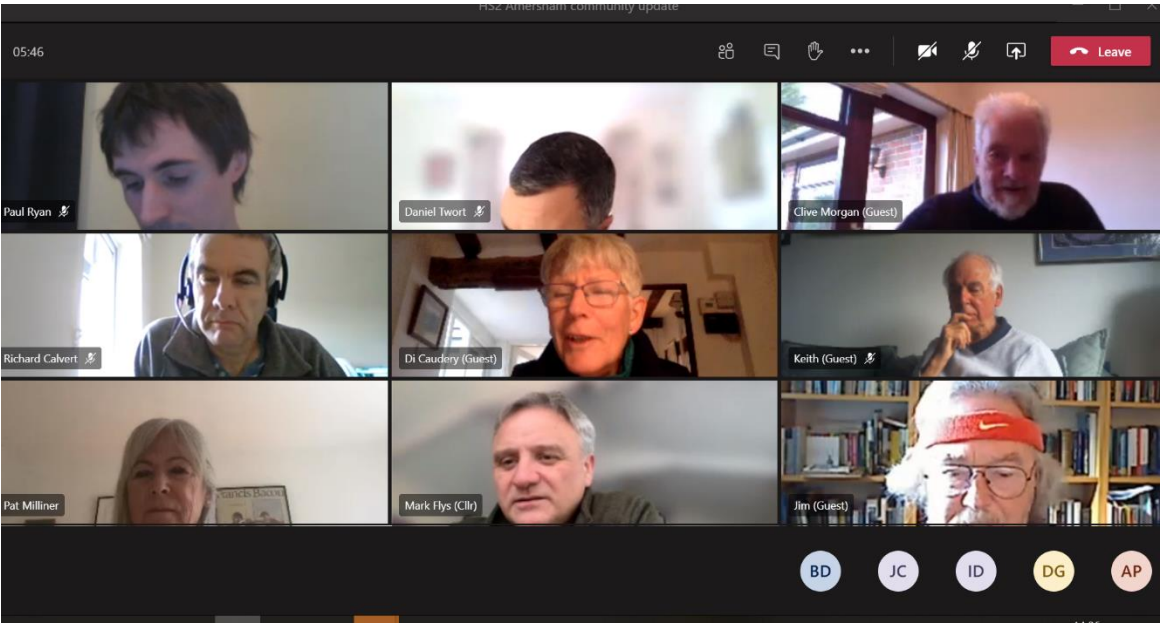
	Local businesses	Other – utilities / statutory/industry	Parish/town councils	Political	Residents / community (groups/ associations)	Residents (individuals)
Tier 1: Stakeholders/ organisations who are significantly impacted by, or have a critical influence on the project	Denham Water Ski Club Hamiltons Car Storage The Old Dairy Tilehouse Studios	Affinity Water Bickerton Aerodrome Blue light services Canal & River Trust National Highways Natural England SSEN National Grid Thames Water BT Open Reach UKPN TfL River Colne Fisheries Woodland Trust	Chalfont St Giles Parish Council Little Missenden Parish Council Great Missenden Parish Council The Lee Parish Council Denham Parish Council Amersham Town Council	Sarah Green MP Joy Morrissey MP Gagan Mohindra MP		
Tier 2: Those stakeholders who are impacted by, or who may have influence or interest in the project	Denham Grove Hotel Hillingdon Chamber of Commerce	Harrow Angling Society Network Rail	Beaconsfield Town Council Coleshill Parish Council		Amersham Action Group Denham Film Studios Harefield TRA Harefield/Musk Marina Maple Cross/ West Hyde RA	BHFL residents Zoe Davidson Tilehouse residents Andy Cordiner Cllr Stephen Burke The Ryalls Wyatt's Covert
Tier 3: Wider stakeholders who have a limited interest and there is little or no engagement	Cutaway WC Camping & Caravan Sarovra Group Regus The Crown & The Red Lion (LM) Denham Park Farm Quarry Harleyford Quarry	SUSTRANS Xtra Services	Chalfont St Peter Parish Council		Great Missenden/South Heath Hyde End Residents Group Chesham Town Council Troy Estate/ Weybeards West London Rangers Rifle Club	Sally Cakebread Steph Lympers The Binns Hillingdon Chairs Harefield Marina residents

Appendix B

Site	Issue update
Chalfont St Peter	Impact on chalk aquifer, water supply, impact on wildlife, EMR (ecological) zone next to the shaft site, closed PROWs, and maintenance
Chalfont St Giles	Noise, dust, light, mud on roads, rat running HGVs, speeding HGVs, impact on chalk aquifer, damage to roads by HGVs, congestion caused by number of HGVs, impact on wildlife and River Misbourne, impact on businesses, impact on residents of TAR, final design of BHFL/A413 junction and impact on property/residents at this location, impact on CSG village of TBMs passing underneath a number of properties both business and residential (noise and vibration), litter dropped by site workers, availability of PROWs and access along BHFL
Amersham	Driver behaviour, parking on Whielden Street by site staff, mud on roads, rat running HGVs, impact on chalk aquifer, water supply, damage to roads by HGVs, congestion caused by number of HGVs, design of Amersham headhouse
Little Missenden	Noise, dust, driver behaviour, mud on roads, impact on chalk aquifer, water supply, safety of vulnerable residents from displacement of traffic caused by congestion/HGV numbers, impact on wildlife, staff parking on verges; poor driving/U-turns on A413
Chesham Road	Rat running HGVs, impact on chalk aquifer, water supply, safety of vulnerable residents, damage to roads by HGVs, congestion caused by amount of HGVs/displacement of traffic onto local roads, impact on wildlife, impact on local property next to the site, loss of trees on site, lighting and noise from the site
North Portal	Rat running HGVs, impact on chalk aquifer, water supply, safety of vulnerable residents, damage to roads by HGVs, congestion caused by amount of HGVs/displacement of traffic, impact on wildlife, lighting and noise from the site, design of North Portal plant building

Appendix C

Example MS Teams meetings with Amersham Action Group



Online KDE example

Headhouse design

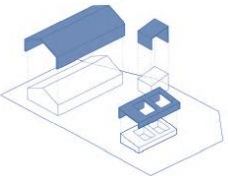
You said: "Design structures that can be concealed or blend into the landscape."
"Can outbuildings be concealed better in short term?"

We did:

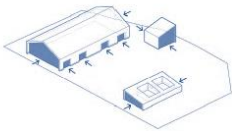
Design inspiration has been taken from the many local historic and industrial agricultural buildings.

The pitched roofs wrap around the buildings, creating simple agricultural barn forms. The stair and vents building has been consolidated into one mono-pitch form, simplifying its appearance and reinforcing the courtyard arrangement.

Openings are pushed in and treated in a different material, similarly to local agricultural buildings. The louvred screen to the transformer substation helps to break up the overall form and hide visual clutter associated with plant equipment.



3D diagram - Form and scale



3D diagram - Louvred openings

Visualisations



Key plan



Visualisation - Public footpath view looking north-east (Year 1)



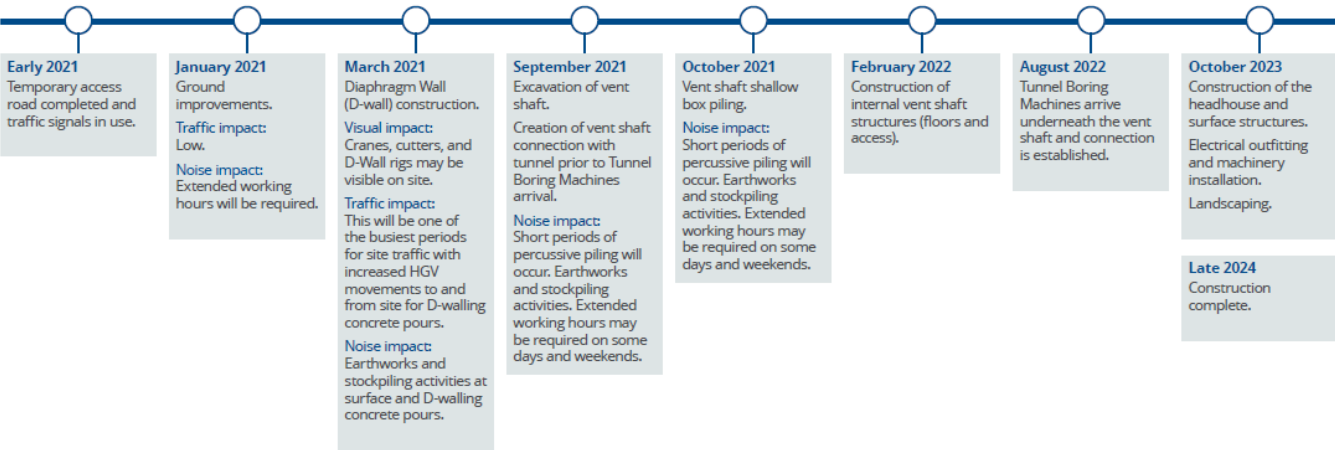
Visualisation - Public footpath view looking north-east (Year 15)

Appendix D

Example of public facing timelines from construction update event

Chalfont St Giles Construction Programme

To minimise our impact on the local community, we will build the vent shaft and headhouse as quickly and safely as possible. Below is an indicative timeline of construction activities. We have highlighted those which may be more noticeable to local residents.



Appendix E

U&A ref id	To Whom	Geographical location	Created from U&A register 22/9/17
6	General	Route wide	HS2 Ltd (and, in due course, the nominated undertaker) will maintain a helpdesk which will enable all property owners and occupiers to contact HS2 Ltd and its property advisers.
26	General	Route wide	The Promoter recognises the importance of public engagement in the design development process. However, the exact scope and nature of public engagement will depend on the element being designed. For example, the project would expect a higher degree of public engagement on those parts of the railway that have the most significant impact on people, such as stations. The Promoter plans to adopt the following approach for public engagement in design development: - Stations - the Promoter will undertake public engagement for stations designs. While the exact form and nature of such engagement will be developed closer to the time, it is likely to be an open engagement exercise, with public exhibitions, leaflet drops, interactive on-line materials and related publicity, reflecting the complexities of station design and the importance of their existing and potential contexts. - Key design elements - the Promoter will engage the public on the design development of key elements of infrastructure - including main viaducts, depot buildings and key ventilation shafts in sensitive areas. See Table 1 for a list of key design elements. The engagement exercise is likely to include many of the elements outlined for stations but will focus more on engaging the public in the locality where the infrastructure is located. - Common design elements - the Promoter will develop standard or common designs for certain permanent structures associated with the railway (such as road-bridges, footbridges, noise barriers). The Promoter will undertake wider public engagement on design development for common design elements, including for example interactive on-line materials, with associated local and route-wide publicity.
33	General	Route wide	Contractors that undertake utility diversions for the nominated undertaker will be required to establish and maintain community liaison arrangements with the owners and occupiers of property affected by their work. The contractors will be required to produce advance information sheets that will be circulated at least two weeks before the construction works are due to start, where it is reasonably possible to do so.

65	General	Route wide	The nominated undertaker will require contractors to communicate regularly with parties affected by the works. Residents and businesses will be informed - appropriately and in advance of the dates and durations of any closures of roads or public right of way and will be provided with details of diversion routes at least two weeks in advance or when final details are available. Advance warning signs of road closures will be provided for users of roads and public of rights of way.
68	General	Route wide	Liaison will continue a more local basis during construction to discuss specific day-to-day issues around construction traffic management as they arise. This is likely to involve the nominated undertaker, the HS2 contractor(s), highway authority officers responsible for traffic management, highway maintenance, street lighting, traffic signals, walking, cycling and public transport services (as well as utility company representatives where necessary).
109	General	Route wide	The contractors will be required to produce advance information sheets that: describe the works to be carried out; explain the expected disruption; and explain the measures being taken to minimise or mitigate the adverse impact of the works.
110	General	Route wide	Where it is reasonably possible to do so: these information sheets will be circulated at least two weeks before the construction works start; a liaison plan will be issued to local authorities listing the communications mechanisms and materials to be offered to local communities. A liaison plan will outline who the project will speak to, when and why and will be created to work in conjunction with the Local Environmental Management Plan (LEMP); and in the case of emergency works, the local authority and residents will be advised as soon as reasonably practicable. Potentially affected residents will also be notified of a 24-hour, seven-days-a-week public helpline number.

111	General	Route wide	The nominated undertaker will be required to follow the general principles of community engagement set out below: respond quickly to emergencies, complaints or other communications, whether these are through the helpdesk or by any other recognised means. Where practical and reasonably possible, the nominated undertaker will respond to complaints with an update within 24 hours; liaise closely with the emergency services, local authority officers and other agencies (through established contacts) who may be involved in incidents or emergency situations; liaise with appropriate local community projects, employment and educational initiatives (see Information Paper G4: Local Training and Employment); ensure that there is a comprehensive emergency crisis plan for each section of the work and contractual recognition that the nominated undertake will coordinate with the relevant emergency services. Preparation should include desktop rehearsals. This will ensure that, in the case of an emergency, the community can be kept fully informed; it will also ensure that adequate arrangements are in place to evacuate an affected area, if necessary, on the advice of the emergency services; provide a point of contact for a small claims procedure, relating to claims of physical damage to property. The nominated undertaker will help to ensure that claims are progressed promptly by liaising with an administrator that it has appointed (see Information Paper C10: Small Claims Scheme); advertise community relations information and contact details (including the HS2 website) on site signboards at prominent site egress and access points; and maintain and advertise a telephone helpline. This will be staffed 24 hours a day to handle public enquiries about construction activities. It will also act as a first point of contact and information in the event of an emergency. All calls (and the responses given) will be logged; action will be taken to address the caller's concerns, and a response will be provided promptly. The helpline will be widely advertised and displayed on site signboards. It will also be possible to contact the helpline service via HS2 Ltd.'s website. Statistical information on complaints will be sent to local authorities and the Planning Forum on a regular basis.
113	General	Route wide	The nominated undertaker will need to track the boring of tunnels and other related activities. It will be required to: distribute leaflets along the route of the tunnel drives, giving notice of the planned passage of the machines.
115	General	Route wide	In general, any site or area-specific community liaison groups or forums will be established nearer the start of construction. Establishment of local forums will be initiated at the request of local communities. The forums will address construction related issues and concerns.

846	Buckinghamshire County Council	Route wide	The Secretary of State will require the nominated undertaker to develop a route wide strategy for archaeology and heritage community engagement and outreach with respect to archaeology and heritage. The content of this route wide strategy will be discussed with the Heritage Sub-group.
1079	Robertswood School	Chalfont St Peter ventilation shaft, Chesham Lane, Chalfont St Peter	The nominated undertaker shall, in accordance with the Code of Construction Practice, give reasonable advance notice of the construction works of the Chalfont St Peter ventilation shaft to the Petitioner.
2050	General	Route wide	As part of the local engagement process, the Promoter will engage with places of worship with a view to avoiding conflict with their activities. In particular through sharing information in advance about the timing of work in the vicinity of their premises. In this way, the Promoter expects that neither the works of the Nominated Undertaker nor the activities of the places of worship will require postponement.
2085	General	Chilterns	The Promoter will work with the relevant local communities in the Chilterns, as part of its engagement during construction, to identify opportunities to provide information on diversions and new routes, including at local rail stations.
2735	Buckinghamshire County Council	Chalfont St Peter	The nominated undertaker shall, in accordance with the Code of Construction Practice, give reasonable advance notice of the construction works of the Chalfont St Peter ventilation shaft to the Council as the Highway Authority, Chalfont St Peter Parish Council, the Robertswood School, the Montessori Nursery, the Epilepsy Society and the Woodland Manor Care Home. For the purpose of this assurance ' - Robertswood school is located at Denham Lane, Chalfont St Peter, Buckinghamshire, SL9 0EW; - The Montessori Nursery is located at Tithe Barn Youth Centre, Sandy Rise Chalfont St Peter, SL9 9TR. - The Epilepsy Society is located at Chesham Lane Chalfont St Peter Buckinghamshire SL9 0RJ; - Woodland Manor Care Home is located at Micholls Avenue, Chalfont St Peter, SL9 0EB

2816	General	Route wide	The nominated undertaker will have a detailed plan for managing community relations before and during construction. The plan will include the Local Environmental Management Plan (LEMP) and locally agreed community liaison plan.
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